Traction Roadmap: Agricultural Compliance Platform

Executive Summary

Timeframe: 12 months (April 2026 – December 2026, extending into Q1 2027) **Primary Goal:** Acquire 5-8 paying customers in Missouri by end of spray season; validate unit economics and consultant channel viability.

Success Criteria: - 15%+ conversion from 20-30 pilots to paid customers (3-5 paying customers by October 2026) - CAC <$700 with consultant partnerships delivering <20% revenue share - 70%+ user activation during spray season (March-October) - 50%+ re-activation rate into Year 2 spray season - 2+ unprompted customer referrals by December 2026

Constraints: - Budget: $20-40K monthly burn; $3.5K-5.6K Year 1 CAC budget - Team: Founder (partnerships/support); 2 senior devs (iOS/Android) locked by Week 1 - Hard deadline: MVP launch by mid-June 2026 to catch tail-end spray season - Existential gate: 2+ consultant partnerships formalized by Week 4 (late May)

Target Customer Profile

Primary Audience (Caspian Archetype): - 10+ properties or 3+ contractors managing applications - 15+ years operational experience, digitizing-ready - Decision trigger: Recent compliance event (audit, peer fine, regulatory change) - Willingness-to-pay: $75-125/month (called it 'no-brainer' in validation)

Where They Are: - Online: LinkedIn (operations managers); email via extension service lists - Offline: Regional ag consultant networks; extension offices; farm conferences

How They Discover: - Warm introductions from trusted consultants/extension (PRIMARY) - Word-of-mouth from peers who've piloted (SECONDARY) - Direct outreach to contractor-heavy ops via LinkedIn (TEST, low-cost validation)

Key Messaging Hooks: - Operational efficiency (recover 30-50% of documentation time) - Contractor management confidence (immutable audit-ready logs) - Proof-based (free seasonal pilot during real spray season, not claims)

Selected Traction Channels

Primary Channel: Consultant/Extension Partnerships (Conditional) - Why: Problem interviews confirmed consultant credibility drives adoption. Warm intros beat cold outreach. - Activation: Free 8-week seasonal pilots (March-Oct) + conversion ask Week 11-12 - Go/No-Go Gate: 2+ consultants committed by Week 4 (late May) with <20% revenue share + 10-15 applicator intros - Expected ROI: 20-30 pilot recruits → 3-5 paying customers (15%+ conversion) - Risk: If fails Week 4, pivot to direct sales (slower, higher CAC)

Secondary Channel: Word-of-Mouth (Post-Pilot) - Why: Applicators trust peer validation more than vendors - Activation: Early customers become advocates; track unprompted referrals - Contingency: If conversion <10%, pause and diagnose (product/messaging/segment) - Expected ROI: 1-2 organic customers from Year 1 pilots by Q4 2026

Testing Channel: Direct Outreach (Founder Time Only) - Why: Validate if consultants filter for right segment or if direct reach finds Caspian archetype - Activation: LinkedIn/cold email to 5-10 hand-selected contractor-heavy operations (founders time) - Budget: $0 - Expected ROI: Segment validation + 0-1 customer; proves channel hypothesis

Quarter 1 Action Plan (April – June 2026)

Week 1-4 (April – Late May): Consultant Partnership Formalization [CRITICAL PATH] - Action: Schedule meetings with 2+ regional ag consultants (goal: <20% revenue share, 10-15 applicator intros); lock written commitments - Owner: Founder - Deliverable: Signed partnerships + consultant intro list by Week 4 - Red flag: <2 consultants committed = pivot to direct sales before MVP build

Week 1-2: EPA Schema Lock [CRITICAL PATH] - Action: Finalize EPA RUP database schema with extension service partner (simplest case: Can X apply Y in Z on date D?) - Owner: Senior dev lead - Deliverable: Schema locked; rework costs 3-4 weeks if missed

Week 1: Lock Dev Team - Action: Confirm 1 iOS dev + 1 Android dev committed full-time - Owner: Founder - Deliverable: Employment offers signed

Week 5-10 (Mid-June): MVP Build - Tasks: iOS/Android offline app + basic contractor logging + EPA RUP database + compliance checking + PDF export + weather integration - Timeline: 9-10 weeks total; launch target mid-June - Deliverable: MVP ready for pilot testing

Q1 Milestone: Consultant partnerships locked (go/no-go gate passed) + MVP launched by mid-June + 20-30 pilot applicators recruited

Quarter 2 Action Plan (July – September 2026)

Week 9-12 (Late June – Mid-July): Pilot Launch + Aggressive Sync Testing - Action: Recruit 20-30 applicators via consultant intros; begin real-world offline sync testing - Owner: Founder (recruitment + support); senior dev (sync debugging) - Deliverable: Pilots active in field; weekly bug fixes from real-world use - Metric: 70%+ activation within 7 days of pilot start

Week 13-16 (Mid-July – Mid-August): Conversion Intent Measurement - Action: Explicit willingness-to-pay ask Week 11 (mid-July); measure re-activation intent Week 12 (late July) - Owner: Founder - Deliverable: Conversion intent data + pilot churn baseline - Target: 15%+ willing to convert to paid; <30% churn during peak season

August-October: Scale Active Pilots + Onboard Early Paid Customers - Action: Continue supporting active pilots; onboard 3-5 converting customers to paid plans - Owner: Founder (customer success); Senior dev (stability) - Deliverable: 3-5 paying customers live by end of October - Metric: CAC tracking (pilot support cost per customer)

Direct Outreach Test (Ongoing Q2): - Action: Founder reaches out to 5-10 contractor-heavy ops via LinkedIn/email - Owner: Founder - Deliverable: Segment validation data (does consultant filter work?); 0-1 customer if successful

Q2 Milestone: 15%+ pilot conversion achieved (or diagnostic needed) + 3-5 paying customers acquired + CAC <$700 validated

Quarter 3 Action Plan (October – December 2026)

October-November: Peak Season Optimization + Churn Monitoring - Action: Support active customers through end-of-season peak; track engagement + churn triggers - Owner: Founder - Deliverable: <5% peak-season churn; customer feedback for Phase 2 features

November: Off-Season Re-engagement Strategy Launch [RETENTION CHANNEL] - Action: Begin monthly value-add outreach (regulatory updates, prep guides for next season) - Owner: Founder - Tactic: Email + phone calls to Year 1 customers; seasonal content calendar - Deliverable: Re-engagement cadence established - Target: Drive 50%+ re-activation into Q1 2027 (next spray season)

December: Year 1 Wrap + Year 2 Planning - Action: Customer feedback interviews (5-8 customers); segment expansion analysis; consultant performance review - Owner: Founder - Deliverable: Year 2 roadmap + messaging refinements - Metric: Word-of-mouth referrals counted (target 2+); customer satisfaction baseline

Q3 Milestone: 5-8 paying customers achieved + 50%+ off-season re-engagement started + Year 1 ARR: $150K-200K (if 5-8 customers @ $75/month avg)

Budget Allocation

Channel Budget (Year 1): - Consultant partnerships: $500 (co-marketing materials, one-time) - Pilot support (labor embedded in founder burn): $0 direct cost - Direct outreach testing: $0 (founder time only) - Regional ag event (REMOVED): $0 - Trade shows: $0

Fixed Costs: - Shared services (legal, accounting, admin): $5K-10K - Cloud hosting (AWS/Firebase): $2K-5K - EPA database (partnership-dependent): $200-500K or partnership-in-kind - Tools (Stripe, analytics, monitoring): $1K-2K - Legal (one-time): $2K-5K

Variable Costs: - Pilot support labor: $200-300 per customer (Founder time, 8 weeks) - Weather API: $0.50-2/user monthly - Payment processing (Stripe): ~3% - Post-pilot support: $30-50/customer (scales after Year 1)

Total Year 1 Burn: $90K-140K net (after early revenue ~$30K-50K from 3-5 customers) **Total CAC Budget:** $3.5K-5.6K (embedded in pilot support labor)

Key Metrics & KPIs

North Star Metric: Monthly Active Applicators (during spray season; all phases: pilots + paid)

Validation Gates (Go/No-Go Decisions): - Week 4: 2+ consultants committed + <20% revenue share (pivot if fails) - Week 16 (mid-August): 15%+ pilot conversion achieved (diagnose if <10%) - October 2026: 3-5 customers paying + CAC <$700 (validate unit economics) - December 2026: 50%+ re-engagement planned (prerequisite for Year 2 viability)

Quarterly Targets: - Q1: Consultant partnerships locked; MVP launched mid-June - Q2: 20-30 pilots active; 15%+ conversion intent measured - Q3: 5-8 customers paying; $2.5K-3K peak MRR (Oct); re-engagement started - Q4 2026/Q1 2027: 50%+ customers return for next season

Operational Metrics: - Pilot activation: 70%+ within 7 days - Pilot churn (during season): <30% - Peak-season churn (Oct): <5% - Unprompted referrals: 2+ by Dec 2026 - CAC: <$700 (track weekly during pilot phase) - Customer LTV: $900-1200 (first 12 months, calculated post-Year 1)

Review Cadence: Weekly during pilot phase (June-Oct); bi-weekly post-pilot; monthly reporting to stakeholders

Risk & Contingency

If Consultant Partnerships Fail (Week 4): - Trigger: <2 consultants commit by Week 4 (late May) - Diagnosis: Consultant interests misaligned; revenue share negotiation failed; market timing - Pivot: Direct sales outreach to 50-100 target operations (via cold email + LinkedIn). Higher CAC ($1K+), slower, but viable. - Timeline impact: 2-4 week delay in pilot launch

If Pilot Conversion <10% (Week 16): - Trigger: <10% of 20-30 pilots willing to pay by mid-August - Diagnosis: Product issue (crashes? UX friction?); messaging misaligned; wrong segment reached - Action: 5-customer feedback sprint to identify blocker; pause new pilot recruitment until fixed - Contingency: Direct outreach test accelerates (validate if consultants filtered wrong segment)

If EPA Schema Misses Week 2: - Trigger: EPA database not locked by Week 2 (mid-April) - Impact: 3-4 week timeline slip; MVP launch pushed to late June (tight) - Mitigation: Extension service partnership escalation; consider MVP scope cut (simplify EPA rules for launch)

If Dev Team Not Locked by Week 1: - Trigger: iOS or Android dev hire slips Week 1 - Impact: MVP timeline unrecoverable; miss spray season (slip to March 2027) - Mitigation: Founder responsibility to secure offers by Week 1 or escalate

If Peak-Season Churn >5% (October): - Trigger: Customer drop-off during highest-value season (indicates product failure) - Action: Immediate support intervention; feature fix or refund + next-season credit - Long-term: Feature prioritization for Phase 2 based on churn root cause

If Re-activation <50% (Q1 2027): - Trigger: Fewer than expected customers return for next season - Diagnosis: Off-season value proposition weak; customer success missed; product needs evolution - Action: Post-season interviews with churned customers; refine retention messaging - Budget: Increase off-season engagement investment (educational content, regulatory alerts)